in any portion of the stomach, they are most commonly found on the lesser curvature close to the antral junction.

## Definition

Gastric ulcer that develop inside the stomach.

Gastric ulcer occurs in the lesser curvature of the stomach to acid secreting parietal cell mass.

## Causes

The most common cause of stomach ulcers is

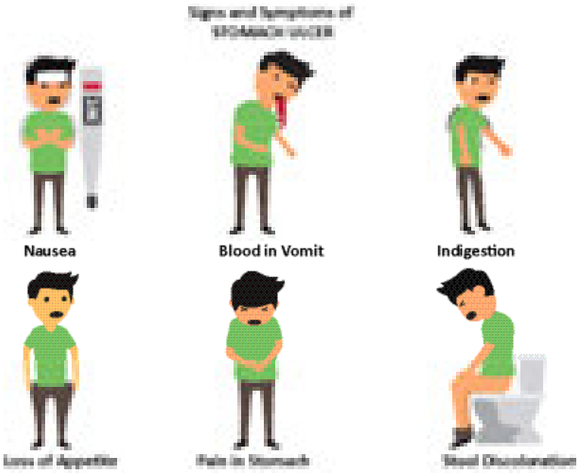
- Helicobacter pylori, or H. pylori infection.
- Ulcers may also be caused by overuse of painkillers, such as aspirin (Bayer), and other nonsteroidal anti-inflammatories (NSAIDs)

### Risk Factors

- Alcohol
- Burns
- Cigarette Smoking
- Drug induced NSAID
- Emotion / Stress
- Family history
- Gastritis
- Hyperchlorohydria
- Injection of toxins

## Signs and Symptoms

- Dull pain in the stomach
- Weight loss
- Not wanting to eat because of pain / Anorexia
- Nausea or vomiting
- Bloating
- Feeling easily full
- Burping or acid reflux
- Heartburn (burning sensation in the chest)
- Pain that may improve when you eat, drink, or take antacids
- Anemia (symptoms can include tiredness, shortness of breath, or paler skin)
- Dark, tarry stools
- Vomit that's bloody or looks like coffee grounds




### Diagnosis

- Barium Meal Study
- Routine blood test
- Oesophago Gastro Duodenoscopy (OGD) Ulcer appear with or without slough or bleeding in their typical locations.
- Gastric secretary Studies.
- Serology to test for H.pylori.
- Breath test to detect H.pylori.

### General Measures

- Avoid use of NSAID drugs.
- Avoid cigarette smoking.
- Well balanced diet with meals at regular intervals.

### Drug Therapy

- Multiple drug regimens are used to treat H.Pylori.

### Surgical Treatment: May perform in advanced disease condition

- Billroth I Partial Gastrectomy with removal of antrum and pylorus of stomach.



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